

EVERYDAY INCOME SECRETS

A simple guide to earning extra income with no experience

HOW TO EARN THROUGH DIGISTORE24 — AS AN AFFILIATE OR AS A VENDOR

This guide is about one specific, real way to earn extra income: Digistore24, a digital marketplace where people either promote other people's products for a commission, or sell their own products and let other people promote them.

Before you start

How to use this guide

This guide is built to be read in order, start to finish. Each module ends with an **Action step** box — a single, specific thing to do before moving to the next module. Do the action step before continuing. The guide works because of the doing, not just the reading.

If you only have ten minutes right now, read Module 1 and Module 2. They will tell you which of the two paths, affiliate or vendor, fits where you are today. Everything after that follows the path you choose.

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How the money actually works

Digistore24 is a digital marketplace and payment processor. People who create digital products (courses, e-books, software, coaching) list them on the platform as “vendors.” Other people, called “affiliates,” promote those products using a unique tracking link. When someone buys through that link, the affiliate earns a commission, and the vendor keeps the rest.

The two roles

- **Vendor:** you create and list a product. You set the price and the commission you offer affiliates. You earn the sale price minus the commission you pay out and minus Digistore24's processing fee.
- **Affiliate:** you promote someone else's product using your own tracking link. You earn the commission percentage the vendor has set, paid out when a sale completes and the refund window has passed.

You can be both. Many people start as affiliates because it requires no product and no money to begin, then later become vendors once they understand how buyers move through the platform.

Setting up your account

Go to digistore24.com, register as a free account, and complete the identity verification steps required for payouts (this usually requires a South African ID and bank account details). Vendors additionally need to pass a product approval process before any product goes live.

Once registered, you can switch between “View as: Affiliate” and “View as: Vendor” inside your account. These are two different views of the same account, not two separate logins.

Action step

Register your free Digistore24 account today, and complete the identity verification for payouts before moving on to Module 2.

Choosing your path

Neither path is automatically better. The right one depends on what you have right now: time, money, or something to sell.

The affiliate path

- Upfront cost: R0. Joining as an affiliate is free.
- Time to first possible payout: as fast as a few days, but realistically a few weeks of consistent promotion before momentum builds.
- What it requires: patience, consistent posting and sharing, and honest evaluation of which products are worth promoting.
- Risk: low. You can't lose money you didn't spend. The only cost is your time.

The vendor path

- Upfront cost: R0 to list, but you need an actual product to sell, which takes time or money to create.
- Time to first possible payout: typically longer, since you also need a sales page, approval, and buyers or affiliates before any money moves.
- What it requires: a real product, a sales page, and either your own audience or affiliates willing to promote you.
- Risk: slightly higher, since you're investing time creating something before any income exists.

A realistic recommendation

If you are starting completely from zero, no product, no audience, no budget, start as an affiliate. It teaches you how buyers think and how the marketplace works, without any financial risk. Once you understand that, the vendor path becomes far less intimidating.

Action step

Decide right now: affiliate or vendor. Write your answer down. If you chose affiliate, skip to Module 3. If you chose vendor, skip to Module 4.

The affiliate route, step by step

Step 1. Switch your account to “View as: Affiliate” and open the Marketplace.

Step 2. Evaluate products before promoting them. Check these four numbers on every listing:

- Commission percentage: how much you earn per sale.
- Price: a higher price with a lower percentage can still pay more per sale than a cheap product with a high percentage. Do the actual math.
- Refund rate: a high refund rate (above roughly 10–15%) usually means a lot of buyers are unhappy after purchase.
- Recency and activity: products with recent updates and active vendors are usually safer bets than abandoned listings.

Step 3. Click “Promote now” on a product you've evaluated and trust. This generates your unique promolink, a personal tracking URL.

Step 4. Share your promolink where real people will actually see it:

- WhatsApp status and relevant WhatsApp groups you're already a genuine member of
- Facebook groups centered on the topic the product solves, not random spam groups
- Your own Facebook profile, posted as a genuine recommendation, not a hard sell
- Friends and family who have an actual problem the product solves

Step 5. Be honest in how you promote. Never claim guaranteed results.

Step 6. Track your link's performance in your affiliate dashboard, and do more of what is working.

Action step

Find one product in the Marketplace today, evaluate its commission, price, and refund rate, and generate your first promolink.

The vendor route, step by step

This module walks through the actual Digistore24 “Add new product” form, field by field.

Product information section

- Product name: your internal reference name, only visible to you.
- Product name for customer: what buyers see at checkout and in emails.
- Product type: choose the option matching what you're actually delivering.
- Affiliate commission: typically 30–50% for digital products.
- Automatically accept affiliations: set to “yes” when starting out.

Pages section

- Sales page: must be a real, live, hosted webpage.
- Thank you page: legally required to contain the exact sentence “The debit will be performed by Digistore24.com.”
- Upsell page: only needed if offering an additional product immediately after.

Sales limits section

For a first product: “Can be bought individually,” no start/stop dates, no sales limit, maximum quantity 1 per sale.

The Deliver tab

This is where you upload the file the buyer receives after payment. A product cannot go live without something attached here.

Getting approved

Digistore24 reviews the product before it goes live, checking that the sales page matches what's being sold, the thank-you page disclosure is present, and the product type matches the delivery method.

Action step

Fill in the product information section of your own listing today, even if you don't have your sales page ready yet.

Getting your first sale

Whether you're an affiliate or a vendor, the same low-budget channels work for South Africans starting with no advertising budget:

- WhatsApp groups and status updates, where trust is already established
- Facebook groups built around the actual problem your product solves
- Facebook Marketplace, useful for vendors with a tangible-feeling digital product
- Warm outreach to people you already know, framed as a real recommendation

A simple weekly routine

- Share your link or product in two to three relevant places per week
- Reply personally to anyone who asks a question
- Track what generates interest and double down on it the following week

This is slow and unglamorous in the first few weeks. That is normal. Consistency over several weeks is what produces a first sale, not a single viral post.

Action step

Pick three specific places, by name, where you'll share your link or listing this week. Write them down now.

Scaling without the mistakes

The most common mistakes that hold South African sellers back:

Missing disclosures

Forgetting the required thank-you page text causes approval delays or account flags. Always double-check the exact required wording.

High refund rates

Overselling what a product actually does leads to refunds, which damages your standing with the platform.

Ignoring tax obligations

Income earned through Digistore24 is taxable income in South Africa. Keep simple records and consult a tax practitioner once earnings become consistent.

Stopping too early

Most people quit in the first month before momentum builds. The first sale is usually the hardest.

Action step

Set a recurring reminder, once a week, to review what's working and adjust your approach for the next week.

You've reached the end

Closing note

This guide gave you the real mechanics of how Digistore24 works, not vague promises. What happens next depends on whether you actually take the first step.

If you have not done so yet, go back to the Action step at the end of Module 1 or Module 2 and do it now. Everything else in this guide only works once you take that first step.